

Vegetarian Pancake Pie

A Vegetarian Pancake Pie is a delicious, crowd-pleasing dish where thin, savoury herb pancakes are layered with a rich, creamy cheese and vegetable filling, and then baked until bubbly. It is similar to a vegetarian version of a Greek *moussaka* or a layered crepe cake.

Ingredients

For the Pancakes:

- 200g (1.5 cups) plain flour
- 2 free-range eggs (or for a vegan/egg-free alternative, use 1 mashed banana or 2 tbsp ground flaxseed mixed with 6 tbsp water)
- 400ml milk (or plant-based milk)
- 2 tbsp fresh herbs (chives or parsley), finely chopped
- Pinch of salt and black pepper
- Vegetable oil (for frying)

For the Filling:

- 2 tbsp butter or olive oil
- 1 medium onion, finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 250g (9oz) mushrooms, sliced
- 150g (5oz) fresh spinach, washed
- 200g (1 cup) ricotta, cottage cheese, or vegan cream cheese
- 100g (1 cup) grated cheddar, mozzarella, or a plant-based alternative
- 1 pinch of grated nutmeg

Instructions

1. Make the Pancakes:

- In a large mixing bowl, whisk together the flour, eggs (or flax/banana), and milk until smooth. Stir in the chopped herbs, salt, and pepper.
- Lightly oil a non-stick frying pan over medium heat. Pour in a small ladleful of batter, tilting the pan to coat the bottom. Cook for 1-2 minutes until golden, flip, and cook for another minute. Repeat until you have 8-10 pancakes.

2. Prepare the Filling:

- Heat the butter or oil in a pan over medium heat. Sauté the onions and garlic until softened (about 5 minutes). Add the mushrooms and cook until browned.

- Toss in the spinach and cook until wilted. Remove from the heat and drain off any excess moisture.
- In a separate bowl, mix your ricotta (or cream cheese) with half of the grated cheese, a pinch of nutmeg, and season well. Stir in the mushroom-spinach mixture.

3. Assemble and Bake:

- Preheat your oven to 180°C / 160°C Fan (Gas Mark 4).
- Grease a standard round cake tin or pie dish. Place one pancake at the bottom, and spread a thin layer of the filling over it. Repeat this process (pancake, then filling) until all ingredients are used up, finishing with a pancake on top.
- Sprinkle the remaining grated cheese over the top pancake.
- Bake in the oven for 20 minutes until the cheese is bubbling and golden-brown. Let it rest for 5 minutes before slicing it like a pie.